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Sony Vaio P VGN-P15G

Portability at a price

The Sony Vaio P could be considered a netbook as it is the smallest and lightest 8-inch display laptop available. It is definitely smaller than any other netbook and you could actually believe those advertisements that you see with it fitting a rear pocket. We received the black colour Vaio P and the top and bottom of it are in a glossy black colour. On the left side of the laptop is a charging port, a USB port and a 3.5-mm headphone jack. On the right side, is another USB port and an extension port. By connecting this extender to the port you can now get two additional ports – a VGA-out port and an Ethernet port. The front of the device has two card reader slots, one for SD and the other for MS Pro Duo memory cards and a Wi-Fi ON/OFF switch. The front is also where the power slider is found, and unlike a simple button, Sony has used a slider similar to that on its PSP.

When you open the lid of the Vaio P you are greeted with a glossy display and a full QWERTY keyboard in silver. This notebook does not have a trackpad as it would have increased the size. Instead, Sony has gone the trackpoint way and has done a pretty good job with the trackpoint that is provided. You can also use the trackpoint with mouse click functions. The keyboard is slightly recessed and has smaller keys, but is very well designed as there is also

spacing between the keys. The edge of the notebook is where the actual mouse buttons are present. A slight flaw we noticed is that when you are typing something and hit the Spacebar, you tend also to hit the mouse buttons.

The native resolution of this screen is quite odd – 1600x768. Using such a high resolution on a small screen means the text will be very tiny and you will need to strain your eyes for these tasks. The display is definitely bright, but the viewing angles of this notebook are just bad. The screen gets totally washed by viewing it from any angle other than straight in front of you.

It did not match up to any of the other netbooks that we have tested and forget about playing any games on this at all. The only good thing when it comes to performance is the 64 GB SSD that it comes with, as the scores in that category were very high.

One thing to be noted is that the base of the Vaio P gets exceptionally hot while charging and also during usage, which we feel is definitely not a good thing.

The Vaio P can't be used for business, nor for gaming. The only option left is for movies, but there is no optical drive and you also have to consider bad viewing angles. This netbook is just average and



really is nothing but a style statement. Nevertheless, it is a lot smaller than any other netbook, so that is a bonus.

Specifications:

Dimensions (W x H x D) – 245 x 19.8 x 120 mm, Weight: 594 g, Processor: Intel Atom Processor Z530 (1.60 GHz, HT Technology supported), 2 GB DDR2 SDRAM, 64 GB SSD.

Ratings

Features: 6.5
Performance: 6
Build quality: 6.5
Value for money: 6
Overall: 6

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Price: Rs. 64,990

Zotac GeForce 8200 ITX

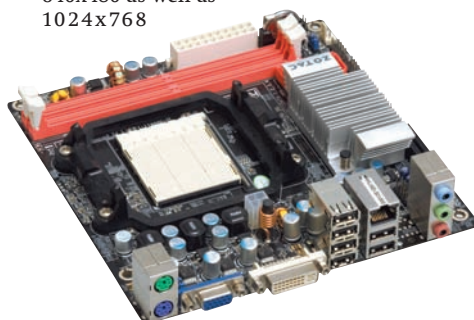
Where size doesn't matter

The new ZOTAC GeForce 8200 we've received is a much more compact ITX version of the ZOTAC GeForce 8200 ATX form factor. This board is aimed towards an all-round entertainment system rather than a hard core gaming rig. Performance shouldn't be affected by its size.

On unpacking, you are presented with quite a well laid out board, of which the AM2+ socket takes up most of the space. There will be a problem for those of you who want to install large CPU coolers, as the memory DIMMs are pretty close to the CPU socket and might get in the way. The 24-pin power connector is located behind the orange memory slots and the 4-pin power connector is on the right side of the CPU socket. There are four SATA ports on this motherboard, but an IDE socket is missing. This motherboard comes with a PCIe x1 slot as the only expansion slot, though a x16 slot would have been a great addition. A Wi-Fi kit is also included with this board.

There is no HDMI port, which is a must have if you want to build an HTPC. An HDMI connection bundles audio and video into a single cable reducing the cluster caused by multiple cables. The workaround from ZOTAC, a DVI-to-HDMI converter, is bundled with the board. Another thing this board lacks is a Digital/SPDIF out.

The performance of this motherboard is almost on a par with the Zotac 8300 ATX, with scores almost matching in the SiSoft Sandra test and even giving good FPS when we tested Doom 3 and FarCry with 640x480 as well as 1024x768



settings. The main drawback we see with this board is a missing PCIe x16 slot. But it will be great for those of you who are thinking of building an HTPC. At Rs. 5,900 it is a good buy and will give you value for your money.

Specifications:

Board size: 170mm x 170mm mini-ITX form factor, Chipset: NVIDIA GeForce 8200, Memory: 2 DIMM slots upto 8 GB memory.

Ratings

Features: 8
Performance: 7
Build quality: 8
Value for money: 7.5
Overall: 7.5

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